



Building Customer Relationships

All customers and clients are valuable to your business—especially those who return, support your brand, and advocate it to others, which you can encourage by building strong relationships.

Keeping customers satisfied

Anyone who buys products or services from your business is valuable, although some customers and clients are more valuable to you than others. While those who make single, one-off purchases have value, the best are those who not only return, but who also support and recommend your business to others.

While some people will only ever make a single purchase, you can encourage others to develop stronger bonds with your business. The first step is to understand who they are and what they need (see pp.40–41). Once you know this, you can create

products and services that meet those needs, then promote them in the most appropriate way to reach your target audience.

To build relationships with your customers and clients, get to know them. Speak to them face-to-face, engage with them on social media (see pp.140–141), and use a customer data system (see pp.130–131). You can then use what you learn to ensure that your products and services not only meet their expectations, but exceed them. Prove to them that they can trust and rely on you through the quality of your offering, customer service, and aftercare.



Marketing

Identify potential customers and clients and develop marketing material designed to attract their interest towards your business.

Communication and campaigns

Use marketing campaigns specifically aimed at your target customers (see pp.140–141) to build interest in the products or services you offer.

Quality and reliability

Provide good-quality products and services that exceed your customers' and clients' needs and expectations.

How to build relationships

Building relationships with your customers and clients is a gradual process that starts with your business appearing relevant to them. Once you have caught their attention, you need to inspire sufficient interest for them to make a purchase. From this point, use your understanding of your customers or clients to develop and sustain good relationships.



Prospective customer

A potential customer becomes aware of your business and may be persuaded to buy from you.

Single purchase

The customer knows more about you and what you offer, which appeals to them enough to make a purchase.